

Market Landscape – Privacy-Rich, Transparency-Poor

Product & Focus

Product: WhatsApp

Focus Area: Consent Management & Personal Data Transparency under the DPDP Act, 2023.

Problem Statement

- Users accept consent without understanding it.
- Privacy settings are scattered and difficult to manage.
- Limited visibility into data collection and usage.
- Growing need for DPDP compliance.

Why This Matters

- User Trust: Users want transparency and control.
- Legal Risk: DPDP requires informed consent and user rights.
- Business Impact: Better privacy builds long-term trust and retention.

Product Mandate

- Improve transparency.
- Simplify consent.
- Enable user data control.
- Ensure DPDP compliance with minimal friction.

Core User Need - "Help me understand and control my personal data without affecting my messaging experience."

Key Insight- Privacy isn't the problem. Lack of transparency and user control is.

Current Ecosystem

Messaging Apps (WhatsApp, Telegram, Signal, Messenger)

Existing Features-

- Privacy Policy
- Permission Requests
- Data Download
- Account Deletion

Core Limitations

- Long privacy policies
- One-time consent
- Scattered settings
- No consent dashboard

Core Gap

Data is collected, but users lack visibility and control.

Assumptions

- Most users skip reading privacy policies.
- Users prefer simple privacy controls over legal text.
- A centralized Privacy Centre will improve trust and DPDP compliance.

Understanding the User

1. Target Persona

Primary Persona: Rahul Sharma

Attribute	Details
Age	28
Occupation	Working Professional
Digital Literacy	Moderate
Device	Android Smartphone
Whatsapp Usage	Daily (Personal & Work)

Uses WhatsApp for:

- Personal chats
- Office communication
- Sharing photos & documents
- Voice & video calls
- Location sharing

2. User Context

- Uses WhatsApp multiple times daily.
- Grants permissions during onboarding without reading.
- Shares sensitive information regularly.
- Rarely visits Privacy Settings.
- Expects WhatsApp to keep data secure by default.

4. Why This Matters

For Users

- Builds trust through transparency.
- Gives control over personal data.
- Makes privacy decisions easier.

For WhatsApp

- Supports DPDP compliance.
- Reduces privacy-related concerns.
- Strengthens long-term user trust and engagement.

3. Pain Points

- Doesn't know what data WhatsApp collects.
- Privacy policy is too long and complex.
- Unsure why permissions are requested.
- Difficult to find or manage privacy settings.
- Doesn't know how to access or delete personal data.

Key User Quote

"I trust WhatsApp with my personal conversations, but I want to clearly understand what data it collects and how I can control it."

"User Opportunity"

Opportunity: Simplify privacy and consent so users can understand and manage their data in just a few taps.

Current Experience and Gap Analysis

1. Current Experience

How WhatsApp Currently Handles Data & Consent

Data Collected

- Phone number
- Contacts
- Profile information
- Device information
- Usage & diagnostic data (where applicable)

Consent Process

- Accept Terms & Privacy Policy during signup
- Grant device permissions (Contacts, Camera, Microphone, Location)
- Privacy settings available under Settings

User Rights Available

- Request Account Info
- Delete Account
- Manage privacy settings

2. Where It Falls Short (DPDP Gap)

DPDP Expectation	Current Gap
Informed Consent	Policies are lengthy and difficult to understand.
Purpose Limitation	Users don't clearly know why each permission is required.
User Control	Consent settings are spread across different screens.
Data Transparency	No single view of collected personal data.
Easy Data Rights	Downloading or deleting data requires multiple steps.

3. Key Friction & Risks

User Friction

- Users skip privacy policies.
- Privacy settings are hard to discover.
- Limited visibility into data usage.
- Confusing permission management.

Business Risks

- Lower user trust.
- Higher compliance risk under DPDP.
- Increased privacy-related support requests.
- Potential reputational impact.

Key Insight - WhatsApp already offers strong privacy features, but the experience lacks transparency and centralized user control, making DPDP compliance harder from a user experience perspective

Proposed Solution – Privacy Control Center

Our Solution

Privacy Control Center

A centralized hub to manage consent, personal data, and privacy settings in one place.

Key Features

-  **Consent Dashboard** – View and manage all active consents.
-  **Data Transparency** – See what data is collected and why.
-  **My Data** – Download, correct, or delete personal data.
-  **Child Privacy** – Age verification & parental consent for minors.
-  **Consent Updates** – Notify users when privacy policies change and request fresh consent.

How It Solves the Problem

For Users

- Clear understanding of data collection.
- Easy access to privacy controls.
- Greater transparency and trust.

For DPDP Compliance

- Informed & purpose-specific consent.
- Supports user rights (access, correction, deletion).
- Better protection for children's data.

Key Takeaway



A single Privacy Control Center makes privacy transparent, gives users meaningful control over their data, and aligns WhatsApp with DPDP requirements—without adding unnecessary friction.

Why This Solution?

Proposed Solution	Why It's Better
Privacy Control Center	One place for all privacy controls
Long Privacy Policy	Low engagement, difficult to understand
Multiple Settings Pages	Scattered and confusing experience

Key Benefits

- ✓ Higher user trust
- ✓ Improved DPDP compliance
- ✓ Simple, user-friendly privacy experience
- ✓ Minimal impact on the messaging journey

Success Metrics

North Star Metric

Valid Consent Rate (VCR)- (% of Monthly Active Users (MAUs) with valid, active, and up-to-date consent)

Target: Increase from **65%** → **90%** within 3 months.

Supporting Metrics

1. Privacy Control Centre Adoption

- % of MAUs visiting the Privacy Control Centre.
- **Target:** >50% within 3 months.

2. Consent Completion Rate

- % of users completing the consent flow.
- **Target:** >95%.

3. Data Rights Requests Completed

- % of download, correction, and deletion requests completed within SLA.
- **Target:** >98% within 48 hours.

Guardrail Metrics

1. User Retention

- Ensure privacy updates do not reduce user retention.
- **Target:** No significant drop in 30-day retention.

2. Consent Flow Drop-off

- % of users abandoning the consent flow.
- **Target:** <5%.

Key Success Criteria

Success means users actively understand and manage their privacy while WhatsApp improves DPDP compliance without impacting engagement.

Success Criteria

What Success Looks Like (Within 3 Months)

Goal	Success Target
Valid Consent Rate	Increase from 65% → 90%
Privacy Control Center Adoption	50%+ of MAUs visit the feature
Consent Completion Rate	95%+ users complete the consent flow
Data Rights Requests	98% requests completed within 48 hours
Privacy Support Tickets	Reduce by 30%
30-Day User Retention	No significant decline after rollout

Success Indicators

- ✓ Users understand what data is collected.
- ✓ Users actively manage their privacy settings.
- ✓ WhatsApp meets DPDP compliance requirements.
- ✓ Privacy improvements do not impact user engagement.

Key Success Statement

The solution is successful when users trust WhatsApp with their data, actively manage their privacy, and DPDP compliance improves without reducing engagement.

Diagnostic Thinking

Scenario

Three weeks after launch, the North Star Metric (Valid Consent Rate) drops by 15%.



Hypothesis Tree

Metric Drop

-  **User Issue** – Users skip or abandon the consent flow.
-  **Product Issue** – Privacy Centre is difficult to find or use.
-  **Technical Issue** – Consent data isn't being saved correctly.
-  **External Issue** – App version, device, or regional rollout issue.



Next Steps

- Fix bugs or tracking issues.
- Simplify the consent flow.
- Improve Privacy Center visibility.
- Run usability testing.
- Monitor metrics after changes.



Data to Analyse

- Consent funnel (step-by-step drop-offs)
- Consent completion rate
- Privacy Centre adoption
- Drop by **Android vs iOS**
- Drop by **App Version / Region**
- Customer support tickets & user feedback



Root Cause Identification

Compare:

- Platform (Android vs iOS)
- New vs Existing Users
- Recent App Versions
- User feedback & error logs

Identify where and why users are dropping off.

Key Takeaway

Use data-driven analysis to identify the root cause before making product changes.

Privacy Control Center Dashboard

Week 4 Post Launch | Privacy Control Center Performance

88%



Valid
consent Rate

52%

Privacy Center
Adoption

96%

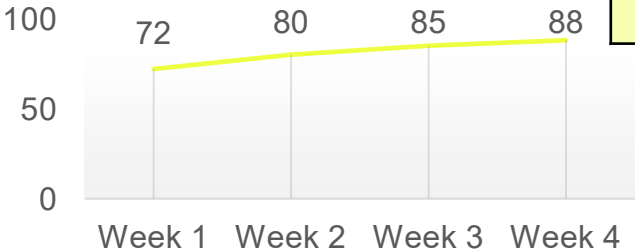
Consent
Completion

98%

Data Requests
(<48 hrs)

Valid Consent Rate Trend

+16% since launch



Metric	Actual	Target
Consent Rate	88%	90%
Adoption	52%	50%
Completion	96%	95%

Dashboard Health

- Consent Rate On Track
- Completion On Track
- Data SLA On Track
- Adoption Needs Attention



Key Insight

Action: Optimize the iOS consent flow to increase the Valid Consent Rate and achieve the 90% target.



Supporting KPIs



Privacy Tickets

↓28%



Avg Consent Time
25 sec



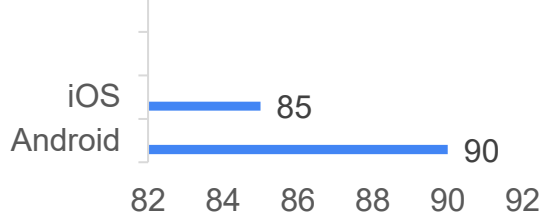
Privacy
Satisfaction Score
4.6/5



Consent Flow
Drop-off
4%



Platform Segmentation



DPDP User Rights Activity



Data Download Requests → 1,200



Deletion Requests → 320



Data Correction Requests → 150

1 🚀 Launch Strategy

Rollout Plan

Phase 1 – Internal Testing (1–2 weeks)

- Test with employees, QA, Legal, and Security teams.
- Verify consent flows, privacy dashboard, and data rights requests.
- Fix usability issues and ensure full DPDP compliance before external release.

Phase 2 – Pilot Launch (5% of Indian Users)

- Roll out to a small user group.
- Monitor consent completion, onboarding drop-offs, crashes, and user feedback.
- Resolve issues before expanding the rollout.

Phase 3 – Gradual Rollout (25% → 50% → 100%)

- Expand in stages based on stable performance.
- Continuously monitor privacy metrics and customer support trends.
- Make the feature available to all users once KPIs are achieved.

🧪 A/B Testing Approach

Cannot A/B Test (Compliance Features)

- Consent requirement
- Privacy notice content
- User data rights
- Child safety requirements

Can A/B Test (User Experience Only)

- Consent screen layout
- Button text (e.g., "Continue" vs. "Accept & Continue")
- Single-page vs. step-by-step consent flow
- Use of icons or illustrations to improve readability

Success Criteria

- 95% consent completion
- <2% onboarding drop-off
- Fewer privacy support tickets
- Higher engagement with Privacy Dashboard

✅ Validation Metrics

- Consent completion rate
- Onboarding drop-off rate
- Time to complete consent
- Privacy-related support tickets
- % of successful data requests (Download/Delete/Withdraw Consent)

Insight

Privacy compliance should build user trust—not create friction. A phased rollout with continuous monitoring ensures legal compliance while maintaining a seamless WhatsApp experience.

Risks & Trade-offs

⚠️ Engineering Complexity

- Build new **Consent Management System and Privacy Dashboard**.
- Integrate **data access, correction, deletion, and consent logs across existing systems**.
- Implement **secure age verification and parental consent for minors**.

📉 Business Impact

- Additional consent steps **may increase onboarding time and slightly reduce new user conversion**.
- **Higher development and compliance costs**.
- Long-term benefit: **Increased user trust and reduced regulatory risk**.

⚖️ Trade-offs Accepted

- Prioritized **legal compliance and user trust** over a faster onboarding experience.
- Accepted a small increase in onboarding friction to ensure **transparent, informed consent**.
- Chose a **phased rollout to reduce risk**, even if it delayed full deployment.

👤 User Impact

- Greater **transparency and control** over personal data.
- Slightly **longer onboarding** due to consent collection.
- **Better confidence** in how WhatsApp handles user privacy.

🔍 Edge Cases

- **Users decline optional consent:** Continue core messaging services while disabling optional features.
- **Child users:** Require verifiable parental consent before account activation (where applicable).
- **Data deletion requests:** Delete personal data within regulatory timelines while retaining legally required records.

💡 Key Insight

Privacy is not just a compliance requirement—it is a **trust-building feature**. Accepting minor onboarding friction today helps create **long-term user confidence, regulatory compliance, and sustainable product growth**.